

Hiring Team
STARK

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Application: Product Manager, Safety Critical Systems

Dear Hiring Team,

I work on systems engineering and functional safety at Vay. Vay operates a remotely driven vehicle fleet in Las Vegas, serving both B2B and B2C customers, with no safety driver in the vehicle. During the time I have owned the systems and safety side, the fleet has grown to around 200 vehicles and continues to grow, and the safety case is a substantial part of what allows it to keep operating and scaling on public roads. That is the aspect of the work I value most: safety and system processes that are not final gates but among the things that let the product move.

Several parts of that work map directly onto this role. I owned our fail-safe fallback manoeuvre (MRM) from the initial concept through to the quantitative frequency targets that gated commercial launch. In practice, that meant establishing what was safe enough to put on the road, and proving it. I am also the safety lead for integrating our stack into our customer's autonomous driving product, working directly with their safety and engineering teams on the architecture and safety concepts. I have also carried the regulatory path myself: the independent TÜV SÜD assessment, the permit documentation, and the scoping decisions on Germany's teledriving ordinance, which had no regulation of its own when we began. My title is engineer, but the work has centred on scope, trade-offs, and deciding where the line sits.

My standards depth is in automotive, principally ISO 26262 and SOTIF. I have not worked to DO-178C, DO-254, or the military standards. The analysis methods underneath them are ones I use daily, though, and I have already carried that toolset once into a domain that had no rules written for it yet.

What STARK is building, and the mission behind it of securing Europe's future, is what draws me to this role. I want to stay on systems that are still being defined rather than ones that are settled. Building the safety case for autonomous systems that have to perform when it matters, early enough to shape the design, is the work I want to be doing.

I am based in Berlin, a German citizen, and I do not anticipate any issue with the required security clearance. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss the role.

Yours sincerely,
Sourabh Porwal